

30 Minutes Expert Copy in Seconds!

To protect against the growing threat of viruses, stupidity (read accidental deletion of data) or the always-in-the-back-of-the-head morbid fear, that our hard drives might crash without warning, backing up regularly is an exercise we can ill-afford to avoid. But doing backups can be a chore that even the most dedicated computer users procrastinate, often until it's too late.

So if a software eradicates the drudgery associated with backup and (gasp!) entices us into becoming committed 'backers', it's definitely worth a few hundred rupees. Second Copy 2000 from Centered Systems (www.centered.com) is one such program.

All we need to do is to add a list of the files we want to backup and Second Copy 2000 will automatically copy these files to a destination of our choice. In networked environments, we can select to back up our data to another machine. In a computer with two hard drives, we can mirror the data on the other drive. This drastically reduces the risk of data loss since it's highly unlikely that both machines (and hard drives) will fail at the same time.

It's simple, really!

Second Copy organises our backup needs into profiles. Each profile defines the set of files/folders that we want to copy, the location where we want to copy these files to and the frequency at which we need backups.

Click on the File menu and select New Profile. This will bring up the New Profile Wizard window, from where you can

TIP

In order to create a new zip file for different dates, create a compressed profile (select Compress from the drop down list of copy modes in the How? tab) and name it Project Report \$DATE\$. Second Copy will now create a new zip file for each day it runs. E.g.
Project Report - 20030310.Zip
Project Report - 20030311.Zip
Project Report - 20030312.Zip



You can schedule the profile to run and copy files at specified time intervals

select either Express setup or Custom setup. Express setup, as the name suggests, is really easy to use and we need only to answer three basic questions (What, Where and When). Once configured, Second Copy monitors the source folder (What) for changes or updates, and copies new or changed files to the destination folder (Where) automatically at the scheduled time (When). Alternatively, we can even create a new profile by simply dragging the folder we want to backup into the Second Copy application window.

More power to the user

Advanced users can use the Custom setup option to define specific rules for including/excluding certain files from the backup operation, along with choosing from six different copy modes, including compressing the files that need to be copied, synchronising the source and destination folders, etc.

Let's suppose you want to backup certain documents, and also wish to preserve the last five versions of these documents.



Specify the files you wish to include in the profile

In order to set up a profile for this specific task, you need to select the Custom setup option from the New Profile Wizard window. Now, select the source folder that contains these documents and click Next. This should get you to the Which files? tab, from where you can manually specify the files to include or exclude from the copy operation. Click the Only selected files and folders radio button, and then click the Select button on the top right. This will open up a new window that will allow you to individually select the documents you want to copy. Alternatively, you can key in wildcards for including specific file types (E.g. *.doc will select all Word documents from the source folder, *Project* will select all files that contain the word Project, etc).



You can choose from several copy modes such as Simple Copy, Exact Copy, Compress, Synchronize, etc

Now, select the destination folder and specify the frequency of backup. In the How? tab, choose Simple Copy from the drop down list. Key in the number of document versions to preserve (five in our case) in the Keep version(s) of deleted files. Now select a folder for archiving, and finally, enter a name for this new profile. That's it. Depending on the periodicity selected, Second Copy 2000 will automatically backup the files and maintain copies of their last five iterations.

Second Copy 2000 completely automates the backup process, and with this wonderful utility installed on our computers there's no reason for us to dread taking backups anymore. ■